JUST HOLD HER

A Foster Mother's Memoir of Medicine, Caregiving, and the Long Nights Together

Judy Wright

Proclamation Honoring Judy & John Wright
Oakland County Board of Commissioners

Foster Parents of the Year
Michigan Supreme Court

John & Judy Wright Scholarship
Ennis Center for Children

> "Would you, please… just hold her until she dies?"

THE STORY

That was the call. Two months old. Four pounds. Blind, deaf, and tethered to monitors, Jayden arrived with thirty diagnoses and no plan. They didn't ask us to save her. They asked us to stay.

Just Hold Her is the relentless, true story of a foster mother's nightwatch. Built from spiral notebooks kept during a two-year vigil, Judy Wright's literary debut captures the collision of medicine, bureaucracy, and human attachment.

In a house governed by two-hour feeding cycles and the shrill cry of medical alarms, Judy traded "big hope" for small mercies. While the system prepared for the end, morning kept arriving — and with it, the quiet defiance of ordinary labor: warming the bottle, checking the numbers, and asking the one question no one else was still asking: What about breast milk?

This is not a rescue story. It is a witness story — for caregivers, foster parents, and the medical professionals who live at the edge of what medicine can do.

COMPARABLE TITLES

- *When Breath Becomes Air* — Paul Kalanithi
- *The Bright Hour* — Nina Riggs
- *Being Mortal* — Atul Gawande
- *The Year of Magical Thinking* — Joan Didion
- *Another Place at the Table* — Kathy Harrison

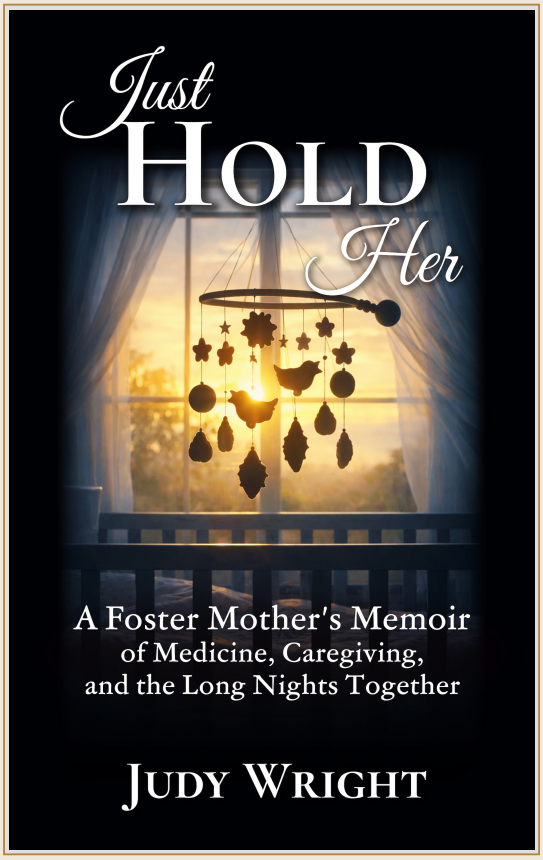
ADVANCE PRAISE

"A fantastic read. A true testament to modern medicine, unconditional love, and compassion. I could not put it down."

Linda Thulin — Nurse, Caregiver, Mother

"You feel every emotion in this book. I found myself holding my breath. A wonderful read."

Jeanette Cunningham — Medical Professional



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ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Judy Wright

Judy Wright is a Michigan mother, foster mother, and caregiver. Over twelve years in Oakland County, she and her late husband John fostered fifty-five children, many medically fragile. Named Michigan Foster Parents of the Year by the Michigan Supreme Court and Oakland County Foster Parents of the Year (Honorable Joan E. Young Award, 2012), their legacy endures through the John and Judy Wright Scholarship for Foster Children, established with the Ennis Center for Children. *Just Hold Her* is her debut memoir.

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